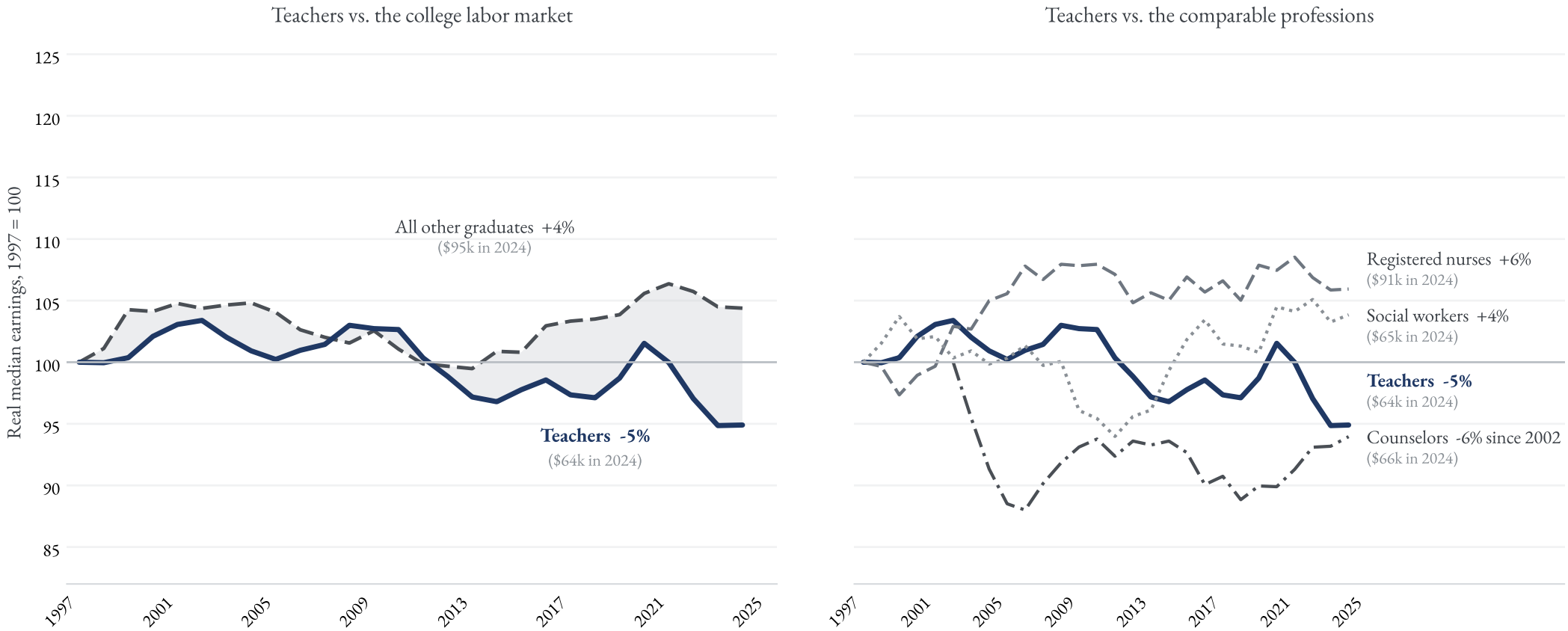
Teachers vs. the college labor market
Real median earnings, 1997 = 100
125
120
115
110
105
100
95
90
85
All other graduates +4%
($95k in 2024)
Teachers -5%
($64k in 2024)
1997
2001
2005
2009
2013
2017
2021
2025
Teachers vs. the comparable professions
Registered nurses +6%
($91k in 2024)
Social workers +4%
($65k in 2024)
Teachers -5%
($64k in 2024)
Counselors -6% since 2002
($66k in 2024)
1997
2001
2005
2009
2013
2017
2021
2025